

Georg von Westphalen

# MedKayfab: Gross Anatomy – Systems Edition

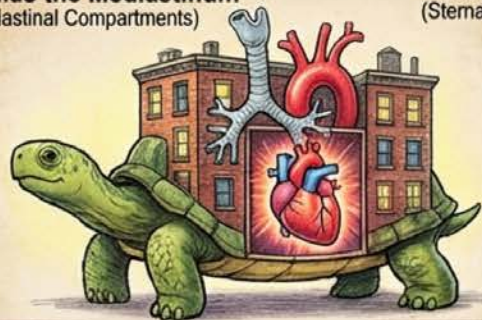
Uncle FrizzleBob's Krazy Kayfabizzaro Komik Kard  
Kult Klub for Narrative Medical Learning Games.





### Medias the Mediastinum (Mediastinal Compartments)

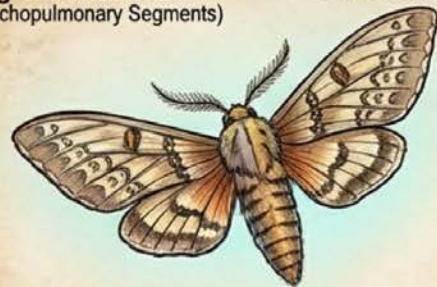
STAT: T4/T5  
(Sternal Angle)



**POWER:** 4Ts Rule (Thymoma, Teratoma, Thyroid, Terrible lymphoma)  
**LORE:** The Sternal Angle (T4/T5) divides the chaos. Trachea bifurcates, aortic arch crosses, SVC forms.

### Lung Lobes Lionel (Bronchopulmonary Segments)

STAT: 10 Right / 8-10 Left  
Segments



**POWER:** Aspiration Gravity  
**LORE:** Right main bronchus is wider and more vertical (25°).  
Supine aspiration hits the right lower lobe's posterior basal segment.

### Pleura Percy (Pleural Recesses)

STAT: -3 to -5 cmH2O



**POWER:** Negative Pressure Vacuum  
**LORE:** Costophrenic recesses (Ribs 8-12) sit below the lung margin.  
Fluid pools here first, blunting the angle on an erect CXR.

### Heart Surfaces Harry (Coronary Anatomy)

STAT: 85% Right Dominant



**POWER:** Oblique Tilt  
**LORE:** RCA sits in the AV groove, supplying the SA (60%) and AV nodes (90%). Inferior STEMI equals heart block risk.



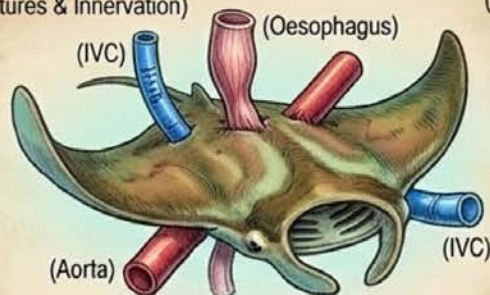
Stay fluffy!



### Diaphragm Diana

(Apertures & Innervation)

STAT: C3, C4, C5  
(Alive)

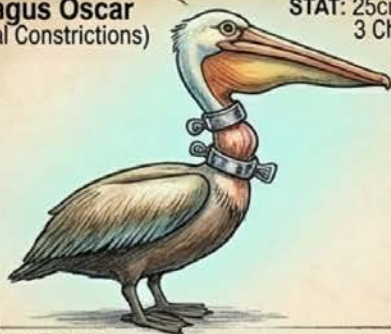


**POWER:** Triple Pierce (18 10 Eggs at 12)  
**LORE:** Irritation of diaphragmatic peritoneum refers pain to the shoulder tip via the phrenic nerve.

### Oesophagus Oscar

(Anatomical Constrictions)

STAT: 25cm Long / 3  
3 Chokepoints



**POWER:** Portal Bypass  
**LORE:** No serosa means early tumor spread. Lower submucosa hosts portal-systemic anastomoses (varices).

### Intercostal Ivan

(Neurovascular Bundle)

STAT: 4th/5th ICS  
(Safe Triangle)

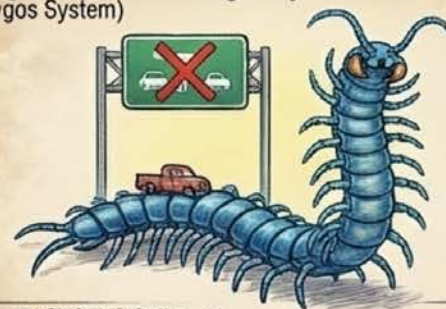


**POWER:** V-A-N Guard  
**LORE:** Vein, Artery, Nerve hide in the subcostal groove. Needles must go OVER the lower rib to avoid disaster.

### Azygos the Venous Highway

(Azygos System)

STAT: T12 to T4  
(Arch level)



**POWER:** SVC/IVC Collateral  
**LORE:** SVC obstruction reverses azygos flow. Visible on CXR as right paratracheal widening.





## Lung Root Rosie

(Hilar Anatomy)

STAT: VPAB  
(Anterior to Posterior)



POWER: Eparterial Gateway

LORE: Left pulmonary artery arches over the left main bronchus. Therefore, the left hilum sits higher on CXR.

## Breast Bessie

(Lymphatic Drainage)

STAT: 75% to  
Axillary Nodes



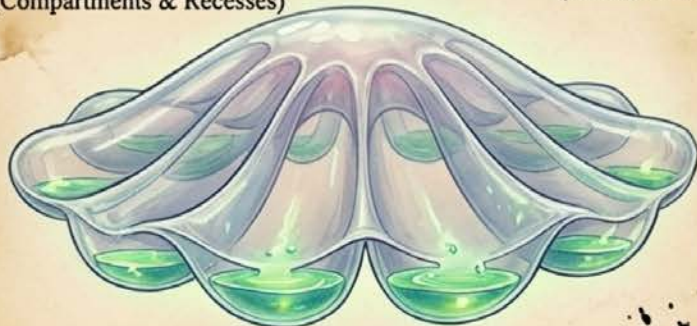
POWER: Sentinel Drain

LORE: Axillary dissection risks the long thoracic nerve (C5-7). Injury causes a winged scapula.

## Peritoneum Petra

(Compartments & Recesses)

STAT: 50-100mL  
(Normal Fluid)



POWER: Dependent Pooling

LORE: Pouch of Douglas (erect) and Morison's pouch (supine) are the lowest points. Free fluid and sepsis collect here.

## Inguinal Ian

(Inguinal Canal & Hernias)

STAT: 4cm  
Oblique Tunnel



POWER: Hesselbach's Breach

LORE: Indirect hernias are lateral to inferior epigastric vessels; Direct hernias push straight through Hesselbach's triangle medially.





## Portal Vein Pete

(Porto-Systemic Anastomoses)

STAT: >12mmHg  
(Portal Hypertension)



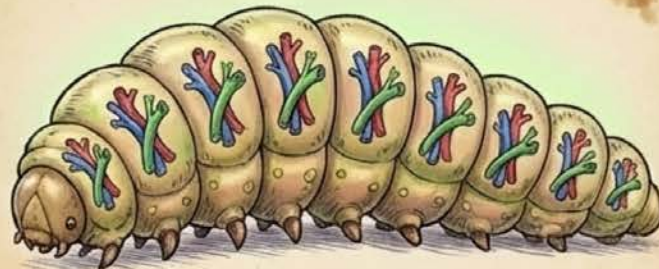
POWER: The 5 Blow-off Valves

LORE: Cirrhosis forces blood through 5 systemic connections: oesophageal, anorectal, umbilical, retroperitoneal, and bare area.

## Liver Lumps Larry

(Hepatic Segments)

STAT: 8 Couinaud Segments



POWER: Cantlie's Split

LORE: Segment I (Caudate Lobe) drains directly to the IVC, sparing it in Budd-Chiari syndrome.

## Pancreas Patricia

(Relations & Ducts)

STAT: L1-L2  
(Body Level)



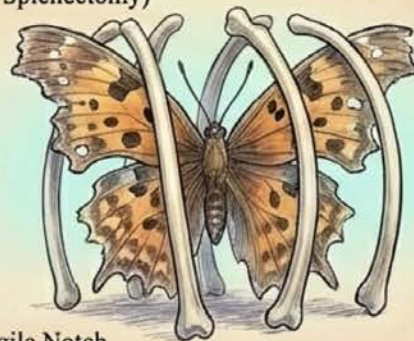
POWER: Courvoisier's Grip

LORE: Carcinoma of the head causes painless jaundice and a palpable gallbladder (Courvoisier's sign).

## Spleen Samantha

(Relations & Splenectomy)

STAT: Ribs 9, 10, 11  
(Posterior)



POWER: Fragile Notch

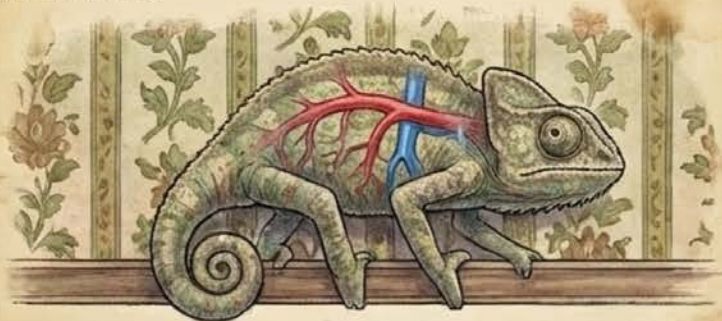
LORE: Intimately related to the gastric fundus, left kidney, and tail of pancreas. Splenectomy risks all three.



## Retroperitoneum Rex

(Aorta & IVC)

STAT:  $\leq 25\text{mm}$   
(Normal Aorta)



POWER: Secondary Stealth

LORE: Left renal vein crosses anterior to the aorta. Compression by the SMA causes left-sided nutcracker varicocele.

## Gut Blood Supply Gus

(Coeliac, SMA, IMA)

STAT: T12, L1, L3  
(Aortic Origins)



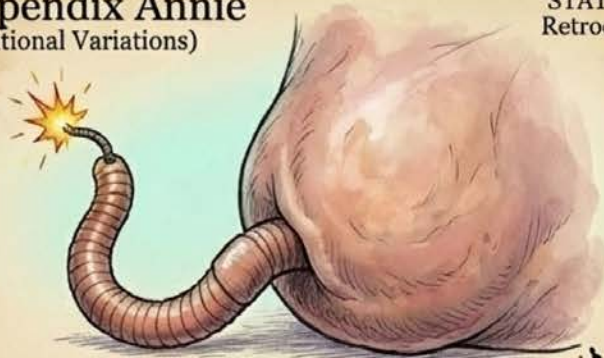
POWER: Watershed Ischaemia

LORE: Griffith's point (splenic flexure) sits between SMA and IMA territories. It is most vulnerable to hypotensive ischaemia.

## Appendix Annie

(Positional Variations)

STAT: 65%  
Retrocaecal



POWER: McBurney's Fuse

LORE: Retrocaecal position masks anterior peritonism but causes a positive Psoas sign on hip extension.

## Hernia Harry

(Abdominal Wall Defects)

STAT: Highest  
Strangulation = Femoral



POWER: Incarceration Trap

LORE: Femoral hernias emerge below the inguinal ligament and lateral to the pubic tubercle. The tight ring strangles bowel.



## Pelvic Floor Paula

(Levator Ani)

STAT: 80-90°  
(Anorectal Angle)



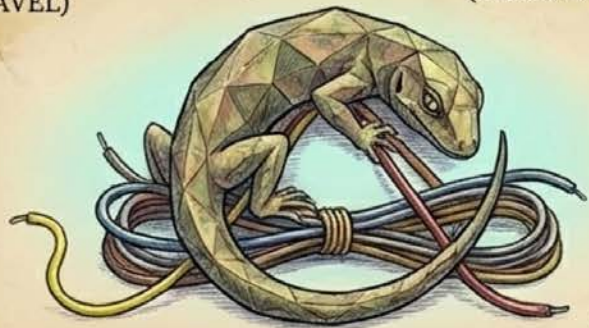
POWER: Puborectalis Sling

LORE: The puborectalis muscle loops the anorectal junction. Pudendal nerve damage (S2-S4) during childbirth causes prolapse and incontinence.

## Femoral Triangle Frank

(NAVEL)

STAT: NAVEL  
(Lateral to Medial)



POWER: Cloquet's Weakness

LORE: The femoral sheath invests the artery and vein, but the femoral nerve remains outside, laterally.

## Perineum Percy

(Anal Canal)

STAT: 2cm  
(Dentate Line)



POWER: Ectodermal Agony

LORE: Above dentate line: portal venous, visceral pain.  
Below dentate line: systemic venous, exquisite somatic pain.

## Gluteal Region Gloria

(Sciatic Nerve)

STAT: L4 to S3  
(Sciatic Roots)



POWER: Piriformis Split

LORE: The sciatic nerve exits below the piriformis. Safe IM injection is strictly in the Upper Outer Quadrant.



## Popliteal Fossa Penny

(Neurovascular Crossroads)

STAT: 2cm  
(Aneurysm Threshold)



POWER: Diamond Crossroads

LORE: Baker's cyst rupture mimics DVT. Popliteal artery is the deepest structure, right on the femur.

## Femur & Knee Freda

(Ligaments & Menisci)

STAT: 20-30°  
(Lachman Flexion)



POWER: Unhappy Triad

LORE: The medial meniscus is attached to the MCL (less mobile, easily torn). The lateral is not.

## Ankle & Foot Angela

(Retinacula & Arches)

STAT: 6cm  
(Ottawa Ankle Rules)



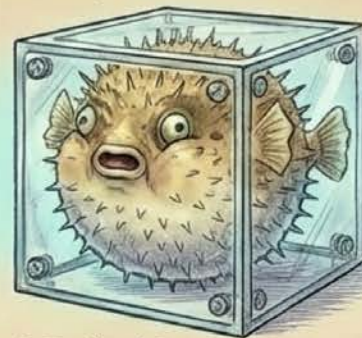
POWER: Tarsal Tunnel (TOM CAT)

LORE: The Anterior Talofibular Ligament (ATFL) is the weakest lateral ligament and most commonly torn in inversion.

## Compartment Syndrome Carl

(Leg Fascia)

STAT: >30mmHg  
(Pressure)



POWER: Ischaemic Feedback Loop

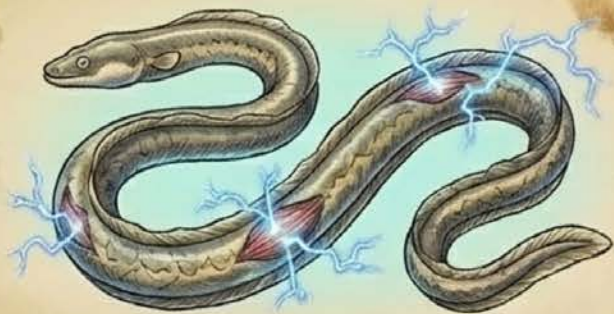
LORE: Pain on passive stretch precedes pulselessness. Fasciotomy must occur within 6 hours to prevent necrosis.



## Femoral & Sciatic Fiona

(Lower Limb Dermatomes)

STAT: L5 Root  
= Great Toe Ext



POWER: Dermatome Mapping

LORE: Common fibular nerve wraps the fibular neck. Injury causes foot drop and first web space numbness.

## Neck Triangles Nora

(Cervical Anatomy)

STAT: CN XI  
(Vulnerable in Post. 1/3)



POWER: Geometric Danger

LORE: Biopsy in the posterior triangle risks the spinal accessory nerve (CN XI). Injury causes an ipsilateral shoulder drop.

## Varicose Veins Victor

(Venous Anatomy)

STAT: 4cm  
(Below Pubic Tubercle)



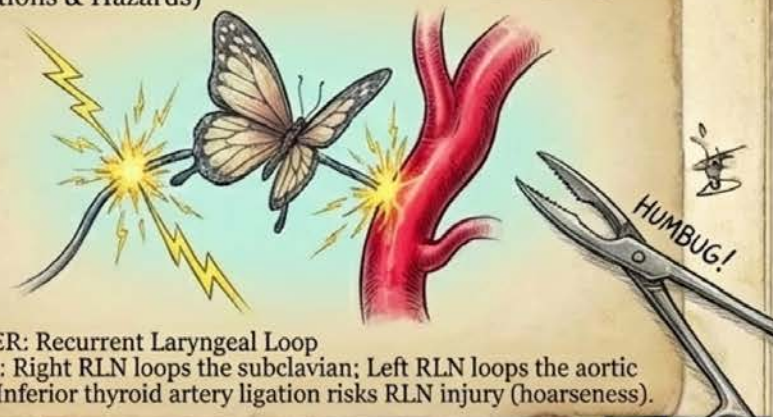
POWER: Valve Reversal

LORE: Incompetent perforating veins reverse flow (deep to superficial), causing venous ulcers in the medial ankle gaiter area.

## Thyroid Anatomy Theresa

(Relations & Hazards)

STAT: 4 Glands  
(Embryological)



POWER: Recurrent Laryngeal Loop

LORE: Right RLN loops the subclavian; Left RLN loops the aortic arch. Inferior thyroid artery ligation risks RLN injury (hoarseness).



## Brachial Plexus Bernie

(Roots to Branches)

STAT: C5 to T1  
(Roots)



POWER: Waiter's Tip & Claw

LORE: Lower trunk (C8/T1) injury causes a claw hand and Horner's syndrome (sympathetic disruption).

## Hand Anatomy Harold

(Carpal Tunnel)

STAT: 9 Tendons + 1 Nerve



POWER: Thenar Wasting (LOAF)

LORE: Ulnar paradox: a higher nerve lesion at the elbow results in a less severe claw hand than a wrist lesion.

## Axilla Alex

(Walls & Nodes)

STAT: 5 Node Groups



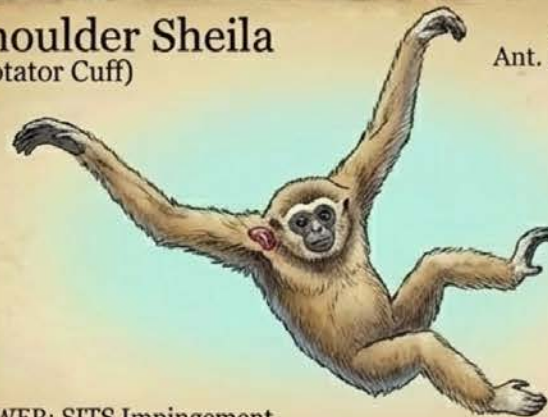
POWER: Quadrangular Squeeze

LORE: Anterior shoulder dislocation compresses the axillary nerve, causing deltoid weakness and regimental badge numbness.

## Shoulder Sheila

(Rotator Cuff)

STAT: 95% Ant. Dislocation



POWER: SITS Impingement

LORE: Supraspinatus initiates abduction (0-15°) but passes tightly under the acromion, risking impingement.



Stay fluffy!

KayfaBLZARRO!



## Elbow Erica

(Cubital Fossa)

STAT: 3 Nerve  
Pinch-Points



POWER: TAN Formation

LORE: Supracondylar fracture in children risks the anterior interosseous artery, causing Volkmann's ischaemic contracture.

## Wrist & Radius Wanda

(Scaphoid & Snuffbox)

STAT: 15-20% AVN  
(Waist Fracture)



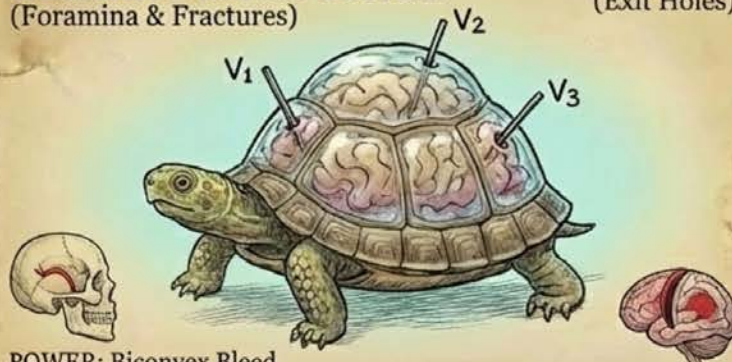
POWER: Retrograde Starvation

LORE: Scaphoid waist fractures disrupt distal-to-proximal blood flow. Snuffbox tenderness after FOOSH equals fracture.

## Cranial Fossae Helen

(Foramina & Fractures)

STAT: V1, V2, V3  
(Exit Holes)



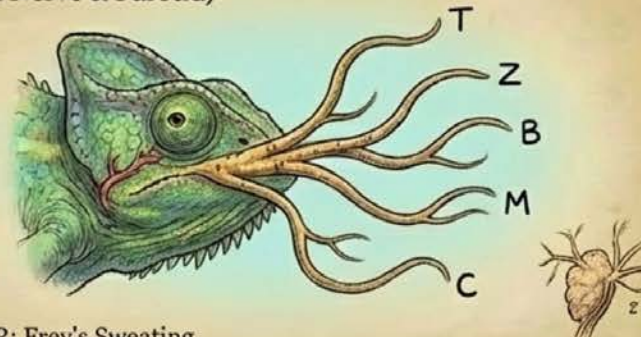
POWER: Biconvex Bleed

LORE: Temporal fracture ruptures the middle meningeal artery. Extradural haematoma causes a classic lucid interval before herniation.

## Face & Orbit Freddie

(Facial Nerve & Parotid)

STAT: 5 Terminal Branches



POWER: Frey's Sweating

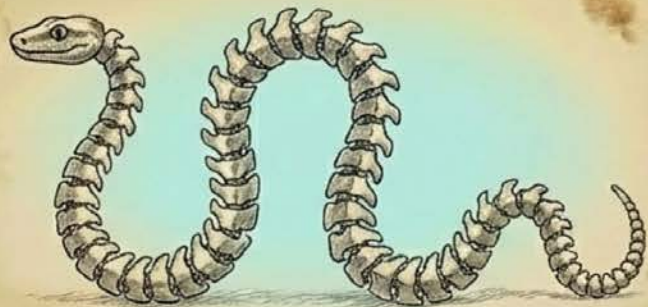
LORE: The facial nerve passes through the parotid gland. Aberrant regeneration after surgery causes gustatory sweating (Frey's).



## Vertebral Column Victor

(Curves & Movements)

STAT: 33 Segments,  
4 Curves



POWER: Regional Tolerance

LORE: Lumbar facet joints face sagittally, locking out rotation to protect the massive lumbar discs from torsional shear.

## Epidural Eve

(Neuraxial Anaesthesia)

STAT:  
L3/L4 (Safe Level)



POWER: Loss of Resistance

LORE: The ligamentum flavum provides the tactile loss of resistance pop indicating entry into the epidural space.

## Disc Disease Duncan

(Herniation Mechanics)

STAT: L4/L5 & L5/S1



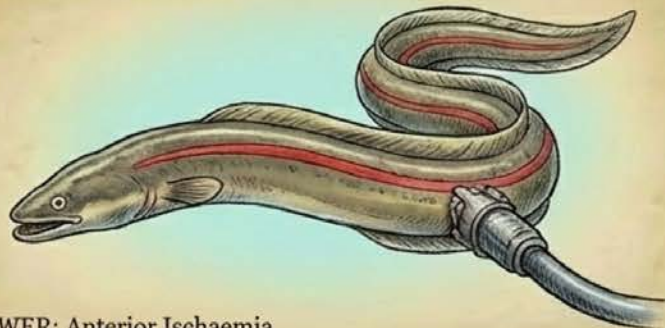
POWER: Posterolateral Burst

LORE: Lumbar roots exit below the pedicle. A posterolateral disc herniation compresses the traversing root below the disc (e.g., L4/L5 hits L5).

## Spinal Cord Blood Sebastian

(Ischaemic Syndromes)

STAT:  
T9-T12 (Adamkiewicz)



POWER: Anterior Ischaemia

LORE: Anterior spinal artery syndrome causes paraplegia and pain loss but spares proprioception (dorsal columns).



### Back Muscles Barbara (Deep & Superficial)

STAT: 3 Deep Intrinsic Layers



POWER: Multifidus Core

LORE: The thoracolumbar fascia cross-links the latissimus dorsi to the contralateral gluteus maximus for kinetic transfer.

### Airway Anna (From Nose to Carina)

STAT: T4/T5 (Carina Level)



POWER: Subglottic Choke

LORE: The cricothyroid membrane is the emergency access point. In children, the complete cricoid ring is the narrowest point.

### Skull Base Steve (Fracture Patterns)

STAT: >8mm (Surgical Elevation)



POWER: Raccoon Eyes & Battles

LORE: Anterior cribriform plate fractures tear the olfactory filaments (anosmia) and leak brain fluid (CSF rhinorrhoea).

### Surgical Approaches Sam (Incision Logic)

STAT: 3 Abdominal Muscle Layers



POWER: Avascular Planes

LORE: Midline laparotomy cuts the linea alba (no muscles cut). McBurney's grid-iron splits oblique fibers without cutting them.

MEDICAL  
—  
SPINE



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## Anatomical Spaces Agnes

(Deep Neck Infections)

STAT: T2 to Diaphragm



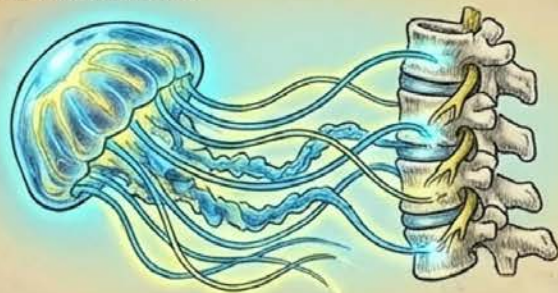
POWER: Descending Necrosis

LORE: Ludwig's angina pushes the tongue up, blocking the airway. Retropharyngeal abscesses track directly to the mediastinum.

## Herniated Disc Harriet

(Cervical Myelopathy)

STAT: C5/C6 (Most Common)



POWER: UMN/LMN Mashup

LORE: Cord compression yields lower motor neuron signs at the level, and upper motor neuron signs (spasticity, Babinski) below it.

## Vessels in Danger Viktor

(Iatrogenic Injury)

STAT: 3 Vital Puncture Sites



POWER: Uncompressible Bleed

LORE: High femoral artery punctures (above inguinal ligament) bleed into the retroperitoneum where they cannot be compressed.

## Pelvic Viscera Paul

(Organ Relations)

STAT: S2, S3, S4 (Nervi Erigentes)



POWER: Water Under The Bridge

LORE: The ureter crosses under the uterine artery. Radical pelvic surgery risks the pelvic splanchnics, causing impotence.



KayfaBONGO!

Wid



## Foetal Circulation Felicity (Neonatal Transition)

STAT: 3  
Fetal Shunts



POWER: Prostaglandin Fall

LORE: High pulmonary resistance forces blood through the ductus arteriosus. Dropping prostaglandins at birth seal it shut.

## The Anatomy Attending (Integrated Cases)

STAT:  
3 Traumatic Cases



POWER: Spatial Logic

LORE: You don't memorize the clinical sign. You memorize the 3D space, and the clinical sign deduces itself.

## Referred Pain Ralph (Dermatomal Convergence)

STAT: T10  
(Umbilicus/Appendix)



POWER: Dermatomal Ventriloquism

LORE: Visceral and somatic afferents converge in the dorsal horn. The brain interprets visceral organ agony as skin pain.

## Uncle FrizzleBob's Golden Rule (The Synthesis)

STAT: 100%  
Interconnected



POWER: Anatomy Anarchy

LORE: The body is a Rube Goldberg machine. Destroy the sterile flashcards. Learn the map!

